

MASON REECE

☎ +1 (919) 805-9931 ✉ mpreece@mit.edu 🏠 Cambridge, MA

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology	2022 – Present
• PhD in Political Science, focus in American Politics and Models & Methods • Dissertation: <i>Essays on Local Political Behavior using Cast Vote Records</i> * Committee: Andrea Campbell, Devin Caughey, and Charles Stewart III (chair)	
Rice University	2022
• BA in Political Science with Honors, BA in Social Policy Analysis, Minor in Data Science • Distinction in Research and Creative Works, Phi Beta Kappa	

WRITTEN WORK

Publications

- *Cast Vote Records: A Database of Ballots from the 2020 U.S. Election*. 2024. Nature Scientific Data. (with Shiro Kuriwaki and 12 others; co-first author with Kuriwaki). Winner of [MIT's Prize for Open Data](#). Media [coverage](#).
- *Postal Voting in the 2020 Election*. Journal of Election Administration, Research and Practice. 2022. (with Lonna Atkeson, MV Hood III, Colin Jones, and Robert M Stein).

Working Papers

- *Even Faster Ideal Point Estimation: Using Variational Autoencoders to Estimate IRT Models*
- *Politics Without the Fight: The Consequences of Uncontested Elections*
- *Partisan Elections and Partisan Voting: Evidence from Judicial Elections* (with Daniel M. Thompson)
- *Trends in Nationalization of State and Local Elections* (with Shigeo Hirano, Joseph Loffredo, and James M. Snyder Jr.)
- *Local community opposition to data centers is clear and growing* (with Adam Rauh and Tyler Simko)

TEACHING

Kaufman Teaching Certificate , MIT Teaching + Learning Lab	2026
TA for Generalized Linear Modeling & Bayesian Inference (taught by In Song Kim)	2025
Designed and taught MIT Political Methodology Workshop: Cluster Computing	2023 & 2024

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

MIT Political Methodology Lab Research Grant	2026
MIT Prize for Open Data	2024
Sallyport Award , considered to be the top undergraduate award at Rice	2022
Judge Woodrow Seals Award for Community Service	2022
Rhodes, Marshall, and Truman Scholarship Finalist	2021-2022
Douglas S. Harlan Award, for demonstrated commitment to political involvement	2021
Morty Rich Scholarship , for commitment and service to Rice and to the greater community	2021
Jesse Jones Leadership Summer in DC Internship Program	2020 & 2021
Rice University Trustee Distinguished Merit Scholarship	2018-2022

PRESENTATIONS

2026: University of Michigan School of Information; American Politics Workshop, MIT; Election Science, Reform, and Administration Conference; State Politics & Policy Conference (poster); American Political Science Association Conference
2025: Election Science, Reform, and Administration Conference; American Politics Workshop, MIT
2024: Southern Political Science Association Conference; Election Science, Reform, and Administration Conference; American Political Science Association Conference (poster)
2023: Election Science, Reform, and Administration Conference
2021: Rice University's Social Science Advisory Board

SERVICE

Mentorship Co-Chair, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council 2025 & 2026

SOFTWARE

[rcvr](#): Clean cast vote records of many types (creator)

OTHER EXPERIENCE

CBS News Election Data Desk 2024 –

- Co-created R/Python pipeline to scrape and analyze election night returns at the precinct-level in battleground states. Worked in real time to provide live election results for the 2024 and 2025 general elections. Collaborated with a diverse team of academics and news analysts. Implementing new machine learning and conformal inference for the 2026 elections.

Research Assistantships

- Assisted with various research projects for: Charles Stewart III (2023-2025); MIT Election Data + Science Lab (2023-2026); Devin Caughey (Summer 2025); Political Methodology Lab (Fall 2024); Robert M. Stein and Elizabeth Vann (2019-2022); Chris Edelson (Summer 2020); A.Kadir Yildirim (2019-2020); Melissa Marschall (2019).

Center for Election Innovation and Research Summer 2021

Head Poll Worker in Cambridge 2022-2024

Head Poll Worker at the Rice Polling Location 2020-2022